

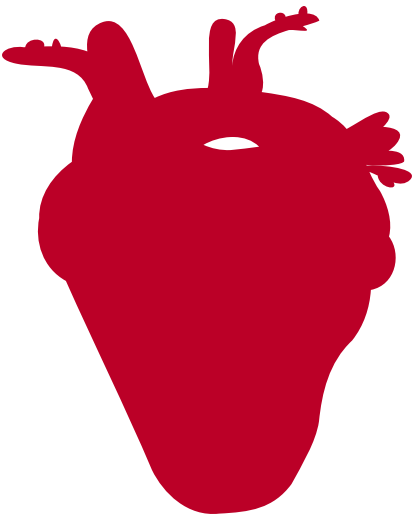
Cartoid means heart-shaped
and comes from Latin.



heart

Pedantic Shapes Kris Kowal 2023

A heart is also a tireless blood
pump made out of meat.

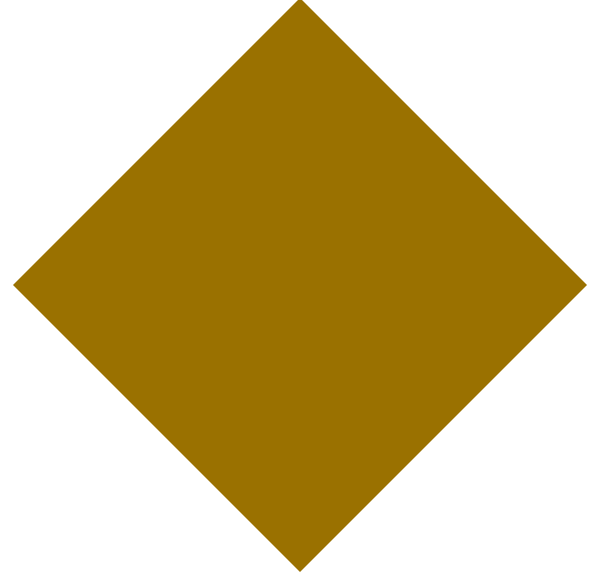


also a heart



square

Tetragon means four-cornered and comes from Greek. Square comes from squadron, from quad, which means four in Latin. Squares are quadrilateral, which means four-sided.



also a square

A square standing on a corner is sometimes called a diamond or a lozenge, but there are other shapes that fit those words better.

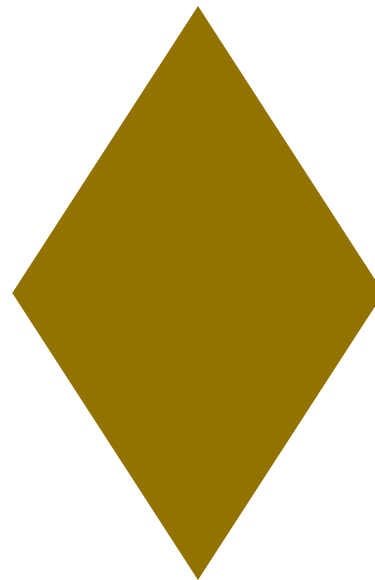


diamond

This shape most closely resembles a literal diamond that has been cut to reflect light, and so arguably is most fitting for the word.



mascle

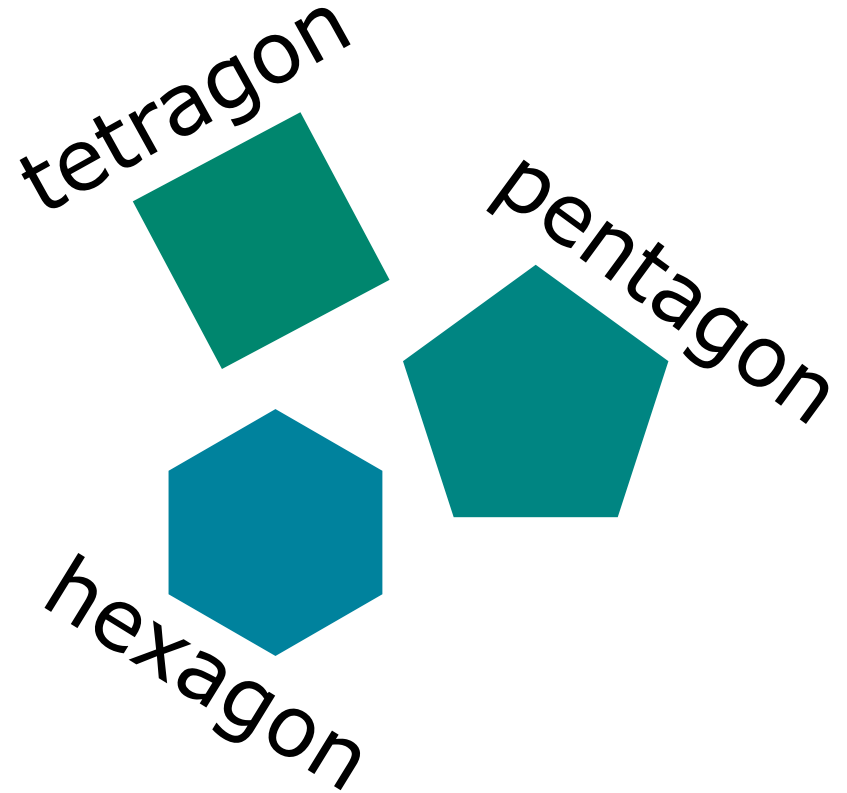


rustre

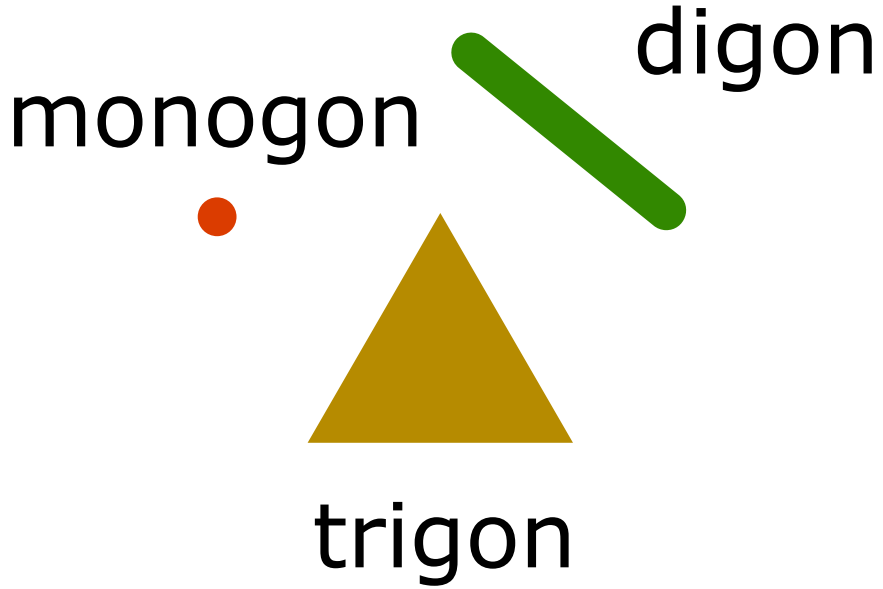
lozenge

Lozenges and rhombuses have four equal sides, but can have unequal angles. A lozenge is tall, narrow, and stands on a corner. Lozenges are also called diamonds.

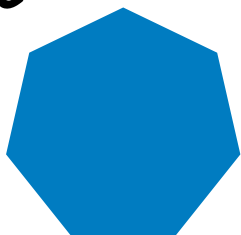
A tetragon has four corners, a pentagon has five corners, and hexagons (arguably the bestagons) have six corners and are excellent.



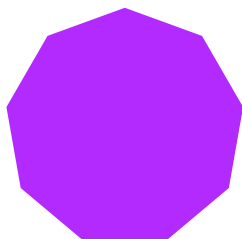
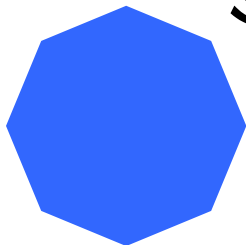
Sometimes we name shapes by counting their corners, deriving from Greek. A monogon is one corner, or just a point! A digon has two corners. Triangle mixes a Germanic word for a bend.



heptagon

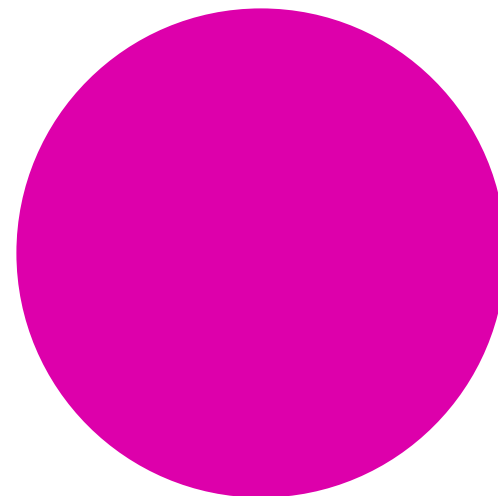


octagon



enneagon

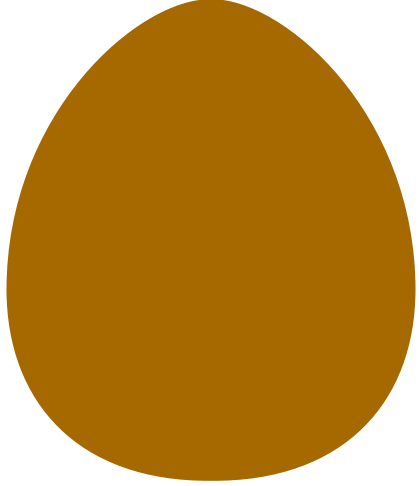
Octogons have eight corners, from the Greek root for eight. But, septagon and nonagon mix Latin prefixes and therefore should be shunned.



circle

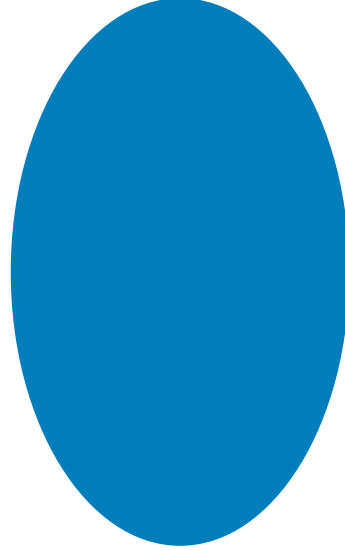
Starting from Greek, a medengon or oudengon would have no corners, pangon or apeirogon would be all corners. Which is a circle?

oval



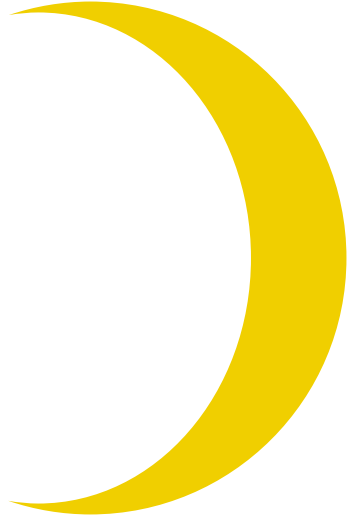
Oval means egg-shaped and comes from ovum, the Latin word for an egg. An oval has a little end, a big end, and might contain a bird.

ellipse



An ellipse might contain the orbit of a star planet, or moon. A circle is a perfect ellipse. Ellipses are not lopsided.

A sphere in the shadow of another
sphere projects the crescent shape.
Croissant is a crescent pastry.



crescent moon

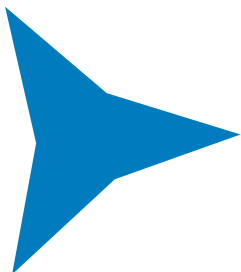
Criss is in X-mas.
Cross is in X-ing.
Trans is in X-fer.



criss-cross

Please join me in fabricating these Greek rooted words for stars from the number of points. Aster means star in both Latin and Greek. The pentaster is called a mullet in heraldry.

triaster



tetraster

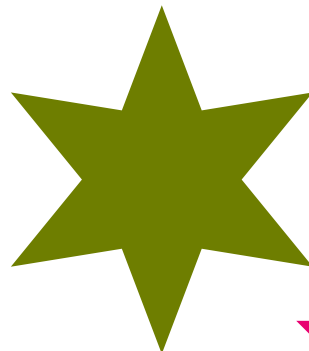


pentaster



Star is from stern, the German cousin of Aster. A hexaster is called a mullet in German heraldry. Estoiles have wavy rays, from the Old French for star. A Sun Star could be called a solaster.

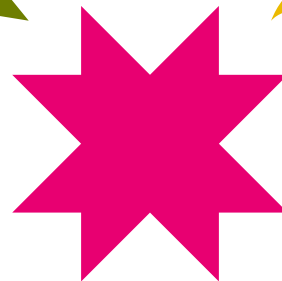
hexaster



estoile



solaster





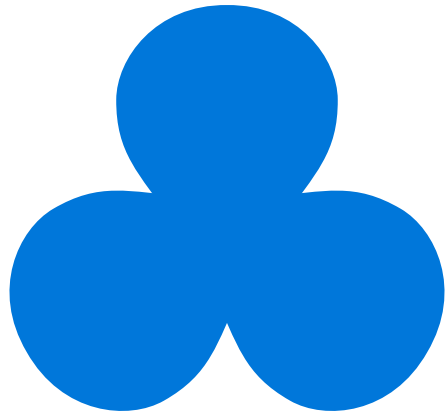
Orion's Belt

For our son, Orion Eärendil.



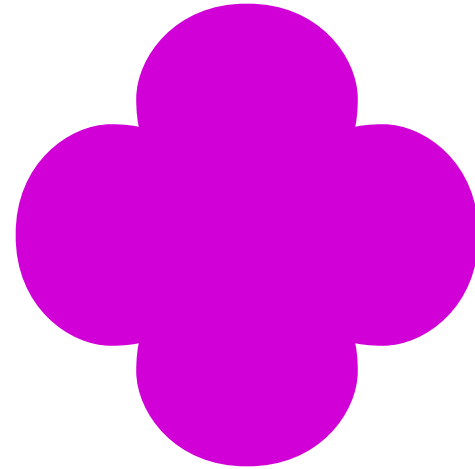
Haley's Comet

For our daughter, Haley Tinúviel.



trefoil

Trefoil is a heraldic word from French that means three-leaf.



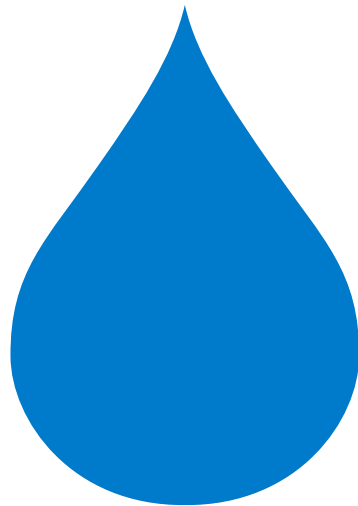
quatrefoil

Quatre-foil means four-leaf.



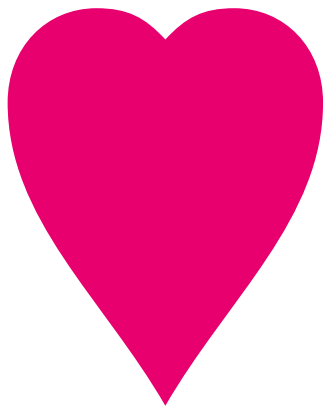
balloon

Balloon is an upside-down droplet,
but sometimes the base is wider,
so it can hold a gondola.

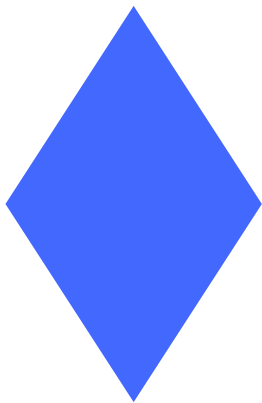


droplet

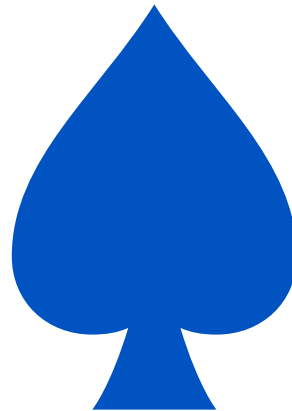
A droplet is an upside-down balloon
but always comes to a point. This
book does not come to a point.



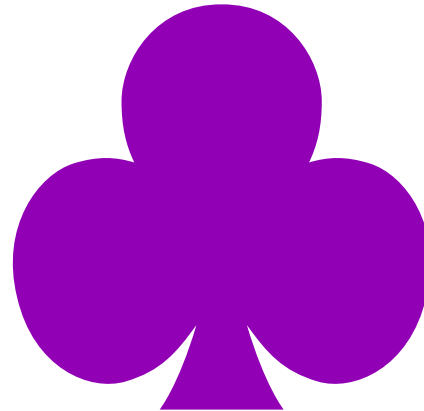
heart



diamond



spade



club

Sometimes a lozenge is a diamond.
You could call the heart-shape
a dudrop. (2-droplets)

A spade is a heart with a handle.
A club is a trefoil with a handle.
Maybe it's a stem.